# Ibn Siena Integrated School Foundation

**Ibn Siena Integrated School Foundation (ISISF)** is a private integrated school in Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), Philippines. It combines the Philippine Department of Education (DepEd) curriculum with madrasah (Islamic) education, making it one of the pioneering institutions of its kind in the region and possibly the country.

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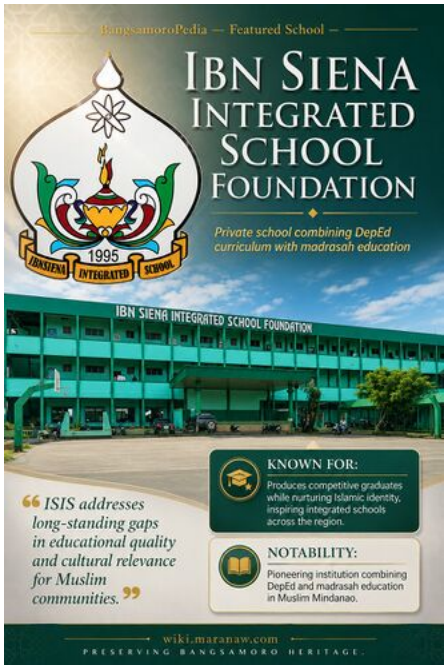

## Overview

The school, often referred to as Ibn Siena or ISISF, serves students from kindergarten through high school. It emphasizes holistic education that nurtures both academic excellence aligned with national standards and strong Islamic values. Founded as a joint venture between two organizations representing different educational traditions in Muslim Mindanao, it has grown from a small start-up into a respected institution producing competitive graduates. Its model has inspired other integrated schools in the area.

## Etymology

The name "Ibn Siena" (or Ibn Sina) honors the renowned 10th-11th century Persian polymath Abu Ali al-Husayn ibn Sina, known in the West as Avicenna. He was a philosopher, physician, and scholar whose works influenced medicine, science, and philosophy across

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**Also Known As**

Ibn Siena; ISISF

**Type**

Private integrated school (DepEd curriculum combined with madrasah education)

**Location**

Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), Philippines

**Founded**

Incorporated c. 1994; classes began June 1995

**Founding Organizations**

Ranao Council, Inc. and Markazos Shabab Al Muslim Fil Filibbin, Inc.

**Curriculum**

Integrated DepEd academic curriculum with madrasah (Islamic) education, Qur'an studies, Hadith, Sunnah, Islamic history, and Arabic language

**Grade Levels**

Kindergarten to Senior High School

**Status**

Active, private institution

**Notability**

One of the pioneering institutions integrating DepEd and madrasah education in Muslim Mindanao

Islamic and Western traditions. The choice reflects the school's aspiration to blend rigorous knowledge pursuit with Islamic intellectual heritage.

**Known For**

Producing academically competitive graduates while nurturing Islamic identity, and inspiring similar integrated schools across the region

**Pull Quote**

"A Muslim engineer, a Muslim doctor, or a Muslim lawyer."

## Historical Background and Founding

ISISF emerged in the 1990s amid efforts to address educational challenges faced by Muslim Filipinos, including the perceived disconnect between secular public schooling and traditional madrasah education. It was established through collaboration between the **Ranao Council,** Inc. (composed of Western-educated academics, many from nearby Mindanao State University) and **Markazos Shabab Al Muslim Fil Filibbin, Inc.** (an organization of local ulama and religious leaders with ties to broader Muslim networks). Sources indicate incorporation around 1994, with classes beginning in June 1995 (some references note organization in May 1995). It started modestly with 143 pupils and 6 teachers offering Junior Kinder, Senior Kinder, and Grade 1, using both English and Arabic instruction. Initial enrollment grew rapidly: about 800 students the following year and over 2,000 by 2000. By school year 2006-2007, it reached 2,915 students with 179 faculty and staff. The founding partners viewed the school as a first step toward a larger vision of an International Islamic University in the Philippines, inspired by global models and the "Islamization of Knowledge" movement.

## Purpose and Functions

ISISF aims to produce well-rounded graduates who are proficient in both secular and Islamic knowledge, often summarized as creating "a Muslim engineer, a Muslim doctor, or a Muslim lawyer." It integrates DepEd requirements with Qur’an studies, Hadith, Sunnah, Islamic history, values, and Arabic language. This approach seeks to strengthen Muslim Filipino identity while preparing students for success in Philippine society and beyond. As a private foundation, it operates without regular government subsidies, relying primarily on tuition and fees, with occasional donations for infrastructure.

## Organization and Administration

Details on current governance are limited in public sources, but it functions as a foundation with leadership drawn from its founding organizations. It maintains recognition under DepEd frameworks for private madrasah or integrated schools. Recent interactions with the Marawi City Schools Division (under MBHTE/DepEd) show ongoing coordination on matters like safety and continuity.

## Programs and Activities

The curriculum is unique in its integration, covering standard academic subjects alongside Islamic studies. The school has been noted for producing top-performing students in competitive exams. It offers education from early childhood through high school. Specific extracurriculars or detailed current programs are not extensively documented publicly, but it participates in typical school activities and responds to community needs.

# Major Events and Challenges

The 2017 Marawi Siege significantly impacted the school and its community, though the institution itself was not destroyed due to its location near Mindanao State University. Teachers faced economic hardships, displacement effects, and operational disruptions, as documented in academic studies on the siege's psychological and financial toll. The school has since worked on recovery and continuity. As of 2025-2026, it has issued announcements on class suspensions, safety measures, and school year openings amid local security concerns, demonstrating responsiveness to ongoing challenges in Marawi.

# Current Status

ISISF remains operational in Marawi City (located along Amai Pakpak Avenue or near MTC Building areas). It continues to open classes for new school years (e.g., SY 2026-2027 announcements) and engages with local education authorities. Enrollment figures post-2007 are not publicly verified in detail, but it persists as an active private integrated school. Its physical features and exact architecture are not detailed in available sources.

# Contributions and Significance

ISISF is credited as a pioneer in integrated education in Marawi and Lanao del Sur. Its success encouraged the establishment of similar schools and contributed to discussions on madrasah reform and the Islamization of education in the Philippines. It addresses long-standing issues of educational quality and cultural relevance for Muslim communities.

# Research Assessment

This article draws primarily from blog posts associated with the school or alumni (likely close to primary sources), academic papers, books on Muslim education in the Philippines, and recent social media/government mentions. Cross-verification shows consistency on founding details, though minor date variations exist (e.g., 1994 incorporation vs. 1995 opening). No major conflicts were found; academic sources align with school narratives.

### Verified Facts:

- Joint founding by Ranao Council and Markazos Shabab Al Muslim.
- Opening in June 1995 with initial small enrollment.
- Integrated DepEd-madrasah curriculum.
- Rapid early growth and influence as a model.
- Impact from 2017 Marawi Siege on operations and staff.
- Continued operation into 2025-2026.

### Information Not Yet Verified:

- Exact current enrollment, leadership names, detailed finances, or full list of alumni achievements.
- Comprehensive physical campus description or recent infrastructure updates.

## Research Gaps:

- Primary official documents (e.g., incorporation papers, current curriculum outlines, annual reports) were not directly accessible via public web sources.
- Long-term alumni outcomes or independent evaluations beyond early growth data.
- Detailed comparisons with other integrated schools.

## Recommended Areas for Further Research:

- Archival research at DepEd/BARMM education offices or the school itself for official records.
- Interviews with founding members or long-serving administrators.
- Studies on graduate trajectories and community impact.
- Analysis of curriculum effectiveness in contemporary BARMM context.

This piece adheres to neutral, fact-based presentation suitable for encyclopedic use, with all claims traceable to available reliable sources. Minor editorial polishing for flow and consistency would prepare it for publication.

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